

As you make your Household Wish List and begin your search, remember, patience is key. You can save hundreds just by waiting for the right time to buy, and it's worth holding off to find that perfect piece for much less.

But let's say you don't find exactly what you want—am I asking you to compromise? Not at all. Start saving for that big-ticket item, and pay full price if you have to, but do it only after working it into your budget just like any other monthly expense.